SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

21 July 2022 · Shift 2

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hold the fort

(A) To stop talking about something
(B) To avoid being found guilty of a crime
(C) To finish something before time
(D) To take responsibility for a situation temporarily

Q.2

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Writing down your thoughts / can has immense positive / effects on your health.

(A) effects on your health
(B) No error
(C) can has immense positive
(D) Writing down your thoughts

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. It will have "detrimental" effects on the healing process.

(A) Insidious
(B) Nasty
(C) Benign
(D) Baneful

Q.4

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Culpable

(A) Guilty
(B) Irresponsible
(C) Immune
(D) innocent

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The mystery behind the extinction of the dinosaurs _____ obscure.

(A) is still
(B) are still
(C) be still
(D) being still

Q.6

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Cryptic

(A) Cloudy
(B) Mystical
(C) Fuzzy
(D) Definite

Q.7

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place where bees are kept

(A) Archive
(B) Hangar
(C) Apiary
(D) Granary

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I think I have left _____ lunchbox at your house.

(A) I
(B) my
(C) me
(D) mine

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The lottery is a regular weekly _____ where the drawing of the numbers is done by a little girl.

(A) instalment
(B) irritant
(C) theory
(D) recreation

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. _____ Paul and Jenny are waiting for you in their office.

(A) Any
(B) Either
(C) All
(D) Both

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Anita looked _____ the word in the dictionary, but she still did not understand it.

(A) to
(B) up
(C) from
(D) after

Q.12

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Foods turn brown and crispy when we cook them because for chemical reactions.

(A) Foods turn brown and crispy
(B) No error
(C) because for chemical reactions
(D) when we cook them

Q.13

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who does a thing for pleasure and not as a profession

(A) Amateur
(B) Ascetic
(C) Abattoir
(D) Anarchist

Q.14

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Kangaroo leather is used to make items / that must be strong and flexible hence it is most / common used in bullwhips.

(A) Kangaroo leather is used to make items
(B) that must be strong and flexible hence it is most
(C) common used in bullwhips
(D) No error

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. He was quick in his anger, but easily “appeased.”

(A) unsatisfied
(B) bugged
(C) dejected
(D) pacified

Q.16

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Sacrifise
(B) Sacrifice
(C) Scarifice
(D) Sacrefice

Q.17

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. “Neither of the political parties have had much” interest in environmental causes.

(A) No improvement required
(B) Neither of the political parties have had any
(C) Neither of the political parties have much
(D) Neither of the political parties has had much

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. This Louis Vuitton bag “costed me an arm and a leg.”

(A) is very expensive
(B) is very cheap
(C) has no warranty
(D) is a fake product

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Her _____ of smell is wonderful.

(A) sacks
(B) sense
(C) science
(D) census

Q.20

Select the option that rectifies the incorrectly spelt words in the given sentence. Let us prepare for the upcomng comptitive exams.

(A) Let us prepare for the upcomming competive exams.
(B) Let us prepare for the upcoming compititive exams.
(C) Let us prepare for the upcomming competitive exams.
(D) Let us prepare for the upcoming competitive exams.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the most basic (1)_____ of a human is food. Food is grown in various parts of the world according to the climatic (2)_____ but one thing that all kinds of crops need (3)_____ an exception is water. We all know (4)_____ water, sunlight, and nutrition from the soil (5)_____ key to a plant’s growth.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) needed
(B) needer
(C) needful
(D) needs

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the most basic (1)_____ of a human is food. Food is grown in various parts of the world according to the climatic (2)_____ but one thing that all kinds of crops need (3)_____ an exception is water. We all know (4)_____ water, sunlight, and nutrition from the soil (5)_____ key to a plant's growth.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) weather
(B) report
(C) conditions
(D) terms

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the most basic (1)_____ of a human is food. Food is grown in various parts of the world according to the climatic (2)_____ but one thing that all kinds of crops need (3)_____ an exception is water. We all know (4)_____ water, sunlight, and nutrition from the soil (5)_____ key to a plant's growth.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) with
(B) above
(C) without
(D) over

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the most basic (1)_____ of a human is food. Food is grown in various parts of the world according to the climatic (2)_____ but one thing that all kinds of crops need (3)_____ an exception is water. We all know (4)_____ water, sunlight, and nutrition from the soil (5)_____ key to a plant's growth.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) then
(B) that
(C) what
(D) when

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. One of the most basic (1)_____ of a human is food. Food is grown in various parts of the world according to the climatic (2)_____ but one thing that all kinds of crops need (3)_____ an exception is water. We all know (4)_____ water, sunlight, and nutrition from the soil (5)_____ key to a plant's growth.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) been
(B) be
(C) is
(D) are

General Intelligence and Reasoning 18 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
79, 81, 84, 89, 96, ?

(A) 106
(B) 109
(C) 107
(D) 105

Q.2

Six boys A, B, C, D, E, and F are sitting in a straight row facing north (not necessarily in the same order). B sits second to the right of D. A sits fourth to the left of F. F is not sitting on the extreme ends of the row. C sits second to the right of B. Who sits second to the right of A?

(A) F
(B) E
(C) B
(D) D

Q.3

Among five friends A, B, C, D and E, C is older than only one friend. E is older than D. Only two persons are older than D. B is older than E. Who is the youngest among all the friends?

(A) D
(B) E
(C) C
(D) A

Q.4

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of letter-clusters. LAB : BAL :: ?

(A) ONM : MNO
(B) PIN : INP
(C) GRB : GRB
(D) TOM : MTO

Q.5

In a certain code language, 'FRIGHT' is coded as '860432', and 'HEAR' is coded as '3156'. How will 'EAFT' be coded in that language?

(A) 1568
(B) 1582
(C) 1528
(D) 1584

Q.6

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All snakes are ants. No ant is a lizard. Conclusions: I: Some ants are snakes. II: Some snakes are lizards.

(A) Only I follows
(B) Both I and II follow
(C) Only II follows
(D) Neither I nor II follows

Q.8

Which two signs need to be interchanged to make the following equation correct? $2 + 5 - 3 \times 6 \div 2 = 14$

(A) + and ÷
(B) × and ÷
(C) – and ×
(D) + and ×

Q.14

Six students, Aryan, Shreya, Arshit, Puneet, Kaushal and Harsh, are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Shreya is sitting second to the right of Puneet. Arshit and Harsh are not the immediate neighbours of Shreya. Puneet is third to the right of Aryan. Harsh is sitting second to the left of Kaushal. Who is the immediate neighbour of Shreya and Puneet?

(A) Aryan
(B) Harsh
(C) Kaushal
(D) Arshit

Q.15

In a certain code language, 'TRICAD' is written as 'FBEJTU', and 'OPQSBG' is written as 'ICURRP'. How will 'ABKLMN' be written in that language?

(A) PNMLOB
(B) PNNLDB
(C) PNNKDB
(D) PMMLDB

Q.16

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) 133 : 666 :: 157 : 786 :: 221 : ?

(A) 1106
(B) 1108
(C) 1105
(D) 1104

Q.17

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. RAT, UEY, XID, ?, DQN

(A) AMI
(B) ANI
(C) ANJ
(D) AMJ

Q.18

In a certain code language, 'LOWER' is coded as '37', and 'OVER' is coded as '06'. How will 'MELON' be coded in that code language?

(A) 95
(B) 28
(C) 82
(D) 59

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No phone is mobile. Some mobiles are telephones. Conclusions: I. All phones being telephones is a possibility. II. Some telephones are not mobiles.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Only conclusion I follows.
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.20

Which two signs and two numbers (NOT digits) need to be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 16 + 15 – 25 × 4 ÷ 5 = 20

(A) × and ÷, 16 and 25
(B) + and –, 4 and 25
(C) × and ÷, 16 and 4
(D) – and ×, 15 and 25

Q.21

In a certain code language, 'CHILDREN' is written as 'OFSEMJID', 'CURTAIN' is written as 'OJBUSVD', and 'LIQUID' is written as 'EJVRJM'. How will 'PERFORMANCE' be written in that language?

(A) FDOBNSPGSFQ
(B) QFSGPSNBODF
(C) FDBONPSGFQ
(D) PQFRPMSADFE

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the fifth word in the same way as the second word is related to the first word and the fourth word is related to the third word. Year : Month :: Week : Day :: Minute : ?

(A) Leap year
(B) Fortnight
(C) Hour
(D) Second

Q.23

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. GAME : IWSW :: HOPE : JKVW :: SOLO : ?

(A) UKRG
(B) UKRF
(C) UKSG
(D) UKRH

Q.25

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (30, 14, 8); (84, 12, 36)

(A) (108, 18, 45)
(B) (68, 14, 49)
(C) (21, 28, 11)
(D) (24, 8, 10)

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

The practice of erecting megaliths began about _____ years ago.

(A) 2500
(B) 1000
(C) 1500
(D) 3000

Q.2

As of April 2022, which neighbouring country of India shares an international boundary with Ladakh?

(A) Myanmar
(B) Bhutan
(C) Nepal
(D) Pakistan

Q.3

Which of the following is a temperate grassland in Russia?

(A) Amazon
(B) Prairies
(C) Congo
(D) Steppes

Q.4

Who won the National Nritya Shiromani award 2022?

(A) Aparna Satheesan
(B) Bhavana Reddy
(C) Vyjayanthi Kashi
(D) Yamini Krishnamurthy

Q.5

Which of the following types of plant is a seed bearing plant?

(A) Thalophyta
(B) Pteridophyta
(C) Bryophyta
(D) Gymnosperm

Q.6

Who was the ruler of Mysore in 1761?

(A) Baji Rao
(B) Murshild Quli Jafar Khan
(C) Hyder Ali
(D) Nizam-ul-Mulk

Q.7

Who was the accused in the murder of Saunders in 1928?

(A) Bhagat Singh
(B) Aurobindo Ghosh
(C) Madan Lal Dhingra
(D) Basant Kumar

Q.8
Which chemical element does ‘Fe’ stand for in the science periodic table?

(A) Fluorine
(B) Oxygen
(C) Fermium
(D) Iron

Q.9
Chitti Babu is associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Guitar
(B) Santoor
(C) Sitar
(D) Veena

Q.10
The first railway line was from _____ to _____ in India in 1853.

(A) Mumbai to Delhi
(B) Delhi to Kanyakumari
(C) Chennai to Nagpur
(D) Mumbai to Thane

Q.11
‘The Test of My Life’ is the autobiography of which of the following persons?

(A) Yuvraj Singh
(B) Ashish Nehra
(C) Zaheer Khan
(D) Mohammad Kaif

Q.12
Who among the following Indian players is also known as ‘Dhing Express’?

(A) Dutee Chand
(B) Neeraj Chopra
(C) Hima Das
(D) PT Usha

Q.13
Who became UNDP India's First Youth Climate Champion?

(A) Prajakta Koli
(B) Ananya Pandey
(C) Amit Bhadana
(D) Bhuvan Bam

Q.14
Indian constitution borrowed a cabinet form of governance from _____.

(A) South Africa
(B) United Kingdom
(C) France
(D) Australia

Q.15
Which of the following is correct about Nagara or North Indian Temple Style Architecture?

(A) There were no tower or shikhara.
(B) It has elaborate boundary walls.
(C) There was no Kalasha, the topmost part of the temple.
(D) The garbhagriha is always located directly under the tallest tower.

Q.16
Who defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in the second battle of Tarain in 1192 AD?

(A) Babur
(B) Iltutmish
(C) Muhammad Ghori
(D) Alauddin Khalji

Q.17
Who among the following was the minister of Agriculture and Farmer's Welfare when the Farm Laws Repeal Bill, 2021 was passed in the Indian Parliament?

(A) Raj Nath Singh
(B) Narendra Singh Tomar
(C) Amit Shah
(D) Dharmendra Pradhan

Q.18
The period between prorogation of Parliament and re-assembly in a new session is called _____.

(A) adjournment
(B) recess
(C) dissolution
(D) cut motion

Q.19
What is the distance between the stumps and the popping crease at the same end of a Cricket pitch?

(A) 1.50 m
(B) 1.34 m
(C) 1.62 m
(D) 1.22 m

Q.20
In which of the following states of India is the Dree festival celebrated?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Assam
(C) Nagaland
(D) Manipur

Q.21
What is the year whose prices are used to calculate the real GDP called?

(A) Fiscal year
(B) Base year
(C) Financial year
(D) Common year

Q.22
Which rivers meet at Devprayag?

(A) Brahmaputra and Subansiri
(B) Beas and Satluj
(C) Bhagirathi and Alaknanda
(D) Chenab and Jhelum

Q.23
For the purpose of Census 2011, a person aged _____ and above, who can both read and write with understanding in any language, was treated as literate.

(A) five
(B) nine
(C) seven
(D) six

Q.24
A balanced diet should meet the RDAs for an individual. State the full form of RDA.

(A) Request Diet Allowances
(B) Recommended Dietary Allowances
(C) Request Dietary Allowances
(D) Recommend Diet Allowances

Q.25
The famous actor Hema Malini is a trained _____ dancer.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Lavani
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Odissi

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.8 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) To take responsibility for a situation temporarily

To 'hold the fort' is to take charge of things for a while, usually while the person responsible is away.

Q.2 · Answer (C) can has immense positive

A modal verb such as 'can' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'can have immense positive effects', not 'can has'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Benign

'Detrimental' means harmful; its opposite is 'benign', harmless or gentle. 'Insidious', 'nasty' and 'baneful' all suggest harm.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Guilty

'Culpable' means deserving blame: 'guilty'. 'Innocent' is its opposite, and 'immune' means protected or exempt.

Q.5 · Answer (A) is still

The subject is the singular 'the mystery', not 'the dinosaurs', so it takes 'is': 'The mystery ... is still obscure.'

Q.6 · Answer (D) Definite

'Cryptic' means mysterious or obscure in meaning; its opposite is 'definite', clear and exact. 'Cloudy', 'mystical' and 'fuzzy' are close to 'cryptic'.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Apiary

An apiary is a place where bees are kept. An archive stores records, a hangar houses aircraft and a granary stores grain.

Q.8 · Answer (B) my

Before a noun the possessive determiner 'my' is needed: 'my lunchbox'. 'Mine' stands alone without a noun, and 'I' and 'me' are not possessive.

Q.9 · Answer (D) recreation

'Recreation' is an activity done for enjoyment, which fits a weekly lottery draw. An 'instalment' is one of the parts in which something is paid or published, an 'irritant' something annoying and a 'theory' an idea that explains something.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Both

'Both ... and' joins two subjects and takes a plural verb: 'Both Paul and Jenny are waiting'. 'Either' would need 'or', and 'any' and 'all' do not pair with 'and' here.

Q.11 · Answer (B) up

To 'look up' a word is to search for it in a dictionary or other reference book.

Q.12 · Answer (C) because for chemical reactions

A reason given by a noun phrase takes 'because of': 'because of chemical reactions'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Amateur

An amateur does something for pleasure, not as a paid profession. An ascetic gives up worldly pleasures, an abattoir is a slaughterhouse and an anarchist rejects all government.

Q.14 · Answer (C) common used in bullwhips

The participle 'used' is described by an adverb, not an adjective: 'it is most commonly used in bullwhips'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) pacified

To 'appease' is to calm someone by giving them what they want: 'pacified'. 'Unsatisfied', 'bugged' and 'dejected' suggest the opposite or a different mood.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Sacrifice
The correct spelling is 'sacrifice', ending in '-fice'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Neither of the political parties has had much
'Neither' takes a singular verb, while the noun after 'of the' stays plural: 'Neither of the political parties has had much interest'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) is very expensive
To 'cost an arm and a leg' is to be very expensive.

Q.19 · Answer (B) sense
Smell is one of the five senses: 'her sense of smell'. A census is an official count of a population.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Let us prepare for the upcoming competitive exams.
The sentence misspells 'upcoming' and 'competitive'. Only 'Let us prepare for the upcoming competitive exams.' corrects both; each of the others still misspells one or both ('upcomming', 'competive', 'compititive').

Q.21 · Answer (D) needs
'One of the most basic' is followed by a plural noun: 'one of the most basic needs of a human is food'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) conditions
Crops are grown according to the 'climatic conditions' of a region, the usual phrase; 'climatic weather' would repeat itself.

Q.23 · Answer (C) without
Every kind of crop needs water 'without an exception', that is in every case.

Q.24 · Answer (B) that
'That' introduces what we know: 'We all know that water, sunlight, and nutrition ... are key'.

Q.25 · Answer (D) are
The subject lists three things, water, sunlight and nutrition, so the verb is plural: 'are key to a plant's growth'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) 107
The differences are 2, 3, 5 and 7, the prime numbers in order. The next is 11: 96 + 11 = 107.

Q.2 · Answer (B) E
A is fourth to the left of F and F is not at an end, so A is first from the left and F fifth. C is second to the right of B, who is second to the right of D, so D, B and C take places 2, 4 and 6, leaving E third: second to the right of A.

Q.3 · Answer (D) A
C is older than only one friend, so C is fourth by age, and D, with two older, is third. E is older than D and B older than E, so B is first and E second, leaving A fifth, the youngest.

Q.4 · Answer (A) ONM : MNO
The letters are written in reverse order: LAB → BAL. Likewise ONM → MNO.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 1582
Each letter has its own digit: from FRIGHT, F = 8, R = 6, I = 0, G = 4, H = 3, T = 2, and from HEAR, E = 1 and A = 5 (H = 3 and R = 6 agree). So EAFT → 1582.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Only I follows
All snakes are ants, so some ants are snakes: I follows. Every snake is an ant and no ant is a lizard, so no snake is a lizard, and II does not follow.

Q.8 · Answer (C) – and ×
After interchanging – and ×: 2 + 5 × 3 – 6 ÷ 2 = 2 + 15 – 3 = 14.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Kaushal
Puneet is third to Aryan's right, so they sit opposite each other, and Shreya, second to Puneet's right, is next to Aryan. Shreya's other neighbour, in the seat between her and Puneet, cannot be Arshit or Harsh, so it is Kaushal; Harsh, second to Kaushal's left, sits next to Puneet, and Arshit next to Aryan.

Q.15 · Answer (B) PNNLDB
The word is reversed and its letters moved +2 and +1 in turn: TRICAD → DACIRT → FBEJTU and OPQSBG → GBSQPO → ICURRP. So ABKLMN → NMLKBA → PNNLDB.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 1106
The second number is five times the first plus 1: 133 × 5 + 1 = 666 and 157 × 5 + 1 = 786. Likewise 221 × 5 + 1 = 1106.

Q.17 · Answer (A) AMI
The first letters move +3 (R, U, X, A, D), the second +4 (A, E, I, M, Q) and the third +5 (T, Y, D, I, N). The missing cluster is AMI.

Q.18 · Answer (A) 95
Add the letters' places in the alphabet and reverse the total: LOWER = 12 + 15 + 23 + 5 + 18 = 73 → 37 and OVER = 15 + 22 + 5 + 18 = 60 → 06. MELON = 13 + 5 + 12 + 15 + 14 = 59 → 95.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Only conclusion I follows.
No statement links phones and telephones directly, so all phones being telephones is possible and I follows. All telephones could be mobiles, so II need not follow.

Q.20 · Answer (A) × and ÷, 16 and 25
After interchanging × and ÷ and the numbers 16 and 25: 25 + 15 – 16 ÷ 4 × 5 = 25 + 15 – 20 = 20.

Q.21 · Answer (A) FDOBNSPGSFQ
The word is reversed and each letter moved one place forward: LIQUID → DIUQIL → EJVRJM and CURTAIN → NIATRUC → OJBUSVD. So PERFORMANCE → ECNAMROFREP → FDOBNSPGSFQ.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Second
Each pair is a unit of time and a smaller unit it is made up of: a year of months and a week of days. Likewise a minute is made up of seconds.

Q.23 · Answer (A) UKRG
The letters move +2, –4, +6 and –8: GAME → IWSW and HOPE → JKVW. So S → U, O → K, L → R and O → G: UKRG.

Q.25 · Answer (A) (108, 18, 45)
In each set the first number is the second plus twice the third: 14 + 2 × 8 = 30 and 12 + 2 × 36 = 84. Likewise 18 + 2 × 45 = 108.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) 3000
NCERT dates the start of megalith building in the subcontinent to about 3,000 years ago; these stone burial markers are found across the Deccan, south India, the north-east and Kashmir.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Pakistan
Of the options only Pakistan touches Ladakh, along the Line of Control on its western side; China lies to its north and east. Nepal, Bhutan and Myanmar border states further east.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Steppes
The steppes are the temperate grasslands of Eurasia, stretching across Russia, Ukraine and Kazakhstan. The prairies are North America's, while the Amazon and Congo basins are covered by tropical rainforest.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Aparna Satheesan
Aparna Satheesan, a Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dancer and a senior disciple of Guru Vyjayanthi Kashi, was chosen for the National Nritya Shiromani Award 2022 for her contribution to Kuchipudi; it was announced in December 2021 for presentation at the 13th Cuttack Mahotsav in Odisha in January 2022.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Gymnosperm
Gymnosperms bear seeds, though not enclosed in a fruit. Thallophytes, bryophytes and pteridophytes have no seeds and reproduce by spores.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Hyder Ali
Haidar (Hyder) Ali took control of Mysore in 1761 and ruled until 1782, followed by his son Tipu Sultan. Baji Rao was a Maratha Peshwa, Murshid Quli Jafar Khan a Nawab of Bengal and Nizam-ul-Mulk the founder of Hyderabad state.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Bhagat Singh
Bhagat Singh, with Rajguru, shot the police officer J P Saunders in Lahore in December 1928, to avenge the death of Lala Lajpat Rai; the killing was among the charges in the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Iron
Fe is the symbol of iron, from its Latin name 'ferrum'. Fluorine is F, oxygen O and fermium Fm.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Veena
Chitti Babu (1936-1996) was a leading Carnatic veena player.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Mumbai to Thane
India's first passenger train ran on 16 April 1853 from Bori Bunder in Bombay (Mumbai) to Thane, about 34 km.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Yuvraj Singh
'The Test of My Life: From Cricket to Cancer and Back' (2013) is Yuvraj Singh's account of his fight with cancer after the 2011 World Cup.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Hima Das
The sprinter Hima Das is called the 'Dhing Express' after her home village, Dhing, in Nagaon district, Assam.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Prajakta Koli
In January 2022 UNDP India named the content creator and actor Prajakta Koli its first Youth Climate Champion, to raise awareness of climate change among young people.

Q.14 · Answer (B) United Kingdom
The parliamentary system, with a cabinet responsible to the legislature, was borrowed from the British (United Kingdom) model.

Q.15 · Answer (D) The garbhagriha is always located directly under the tallest tower.
In the Nagara style the sanctum (garbhagriha) lies directly beneath the tallest tower, the shikhara. Nagara temples do have shikharas, crowned by an amalaka and a kalasha, and usually lack the elaborate boundary walls and gateways of the Dravida style.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Muhammad Ghori
Muhammad Ghori defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in the second battle of Tarain in 1192, a year after losing the first battle to him.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Narendra Singh Tomar
Narendra Singh Tomar was the Union Minister of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare when both Houses passed the Farm Laws Repeal Bill, 2021 on 29 November 2021; he moved it in the Lok Sabha.

Q.18 · Answer (B) recess
The gap between the prorogation of a House and its reassembly in a new session is a recess. An adjournment suspends a sitting, dissolution ends the life of the Lok Sabha, and a cut motion seeks to reduce a demand for grants.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 1.22 m
The popping crease is marked 4 feet (1.22 m) in front of the bowling crease, the line on which the stumps stand.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Arunachal Pradesh
Dree is the agricultural festival of the Apatani people of the Ziro valley in Arunachal Pradesh, held in July with prayers for a good harvest.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Base year
Real GDP values output at the prices of a chosen base year, so that changes reflect quantities produced rather than price rises.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Bhagirathi and Alaknanda
At Devprayag in Uttarakhand the Bhagirathi and the Alaknanda meet to form the Ganga.

Q.23 · Answer (C) seven
Census 2011 counted as literate a person aged seven and above who can both read and write with understanding in any language.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Recommended Dietary Allowances
RDA stands for Recommended Dietary Allowances, the daily amounts of energy and nutrients advised to meet the needs of nearly all healthy people of a given age, sex and activity level.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam
SSC's key gives Bharatanatyam, the classical form Hema Malini trained in and is best known for. She also studied Kuchipudi, with Vempati Chinna Satyam, which makes that option arguable, but she is described above all as a Bharatanatyam dancer.

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